Introduction

Water is one of the basic substance present in the earth. It plays a vital role in the evolution and survival of life. It is impossible to imagine life on the earth without water. Water helps to regulate the temperature of our planet. It also helps to maintain the temperature in organisms.

2.1 Where do we get water from?

We need water to perform several day to day activities like cooking food, washing clothes, cleaning utensils etc.

We get water from different water sources in our surroundings. In villages / towns wells, canals, tanks, ponds, rivers, water tanks, hand pipes are the main sources of water.

List out the sources from where you get water in your village/town.

For example Ramu says he and his family get water from the pipes in washrooms and kitchens. Sankar says he has to use handpump daily both in the morning and evening to collect the water. Raja says his mother used to get up early and walks to pond to get water.

Where do you get water for your household uses?

2.2 Where and how water is found on the earth?

Water is available in nature in three forms – Solid, Liquid , Vapour.

- **Solid form of water - Ice** - It is present in ice bergs and ice caps on top of tall mountains, galaciers and polar regions.
- **Liquid form of water – Water** – It is present in oceans, seas, lakes, rivers and even underground.
- **Gaseous form of water – Vapour** – It is present in the air around us.

2.3 Availability of water

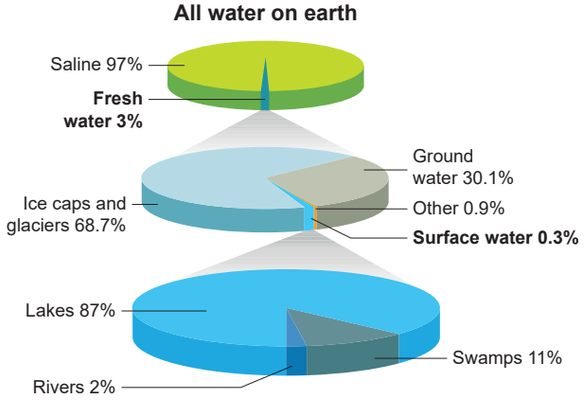
We know that nearly $\frac{3}{4}^{th}$ of the surface of the earth is covered by water. Most of the water, that is 97% of the total amount of water that exits on earth is found in seas and oceans.

Can we drink the water available in the sea?

Sea water is salty. But water used for our daily purposes is not salty. It is known as fresh water. Water obtained from ponds, puddles, river, tube-wells and taps at home is usually fresh water.

If the total water on earth be 100%, let's see what percent would be the availability of fresh water.

Look at the pie chart given below.



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